

Philipp Hilbert. *Payments operations PM who owns the details, not just the backlog.*

Positioning, Thirteen years of end-to-end product ownership in regulated, detail-heavy domains, from fintech P2P payments to public-sector analytics, with a track record of cutting complexity down to what actually ships.

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§ WHY PRIMER

Primer sits at exactly the layer where payments get hard: not the checkout moment, but the reconciliation, the settlement breaks, the FX edge cases that emerge at scale. The job description is honest that this work is unforgiving, and that is a signal of product seriousness rather than a warning. The explicit call for someone who can "write specs that anticipate the edge cases that actually matter in payments operations" matches how I have worked across every regulated domain I have owned. *That is the kind of detail-heavy, consequence-real product environment where I do my clearest thinking.*

§ HONEST FRAMING

I have not owned a reconciliation ledger or a treasury FX product before in a named PM role. I have shipped a P2P payments product from zero to acquisition and owned payment POS systems at Scheidt & Bachmann, so the domain logic is not foreign, but I will call the reconciliation and Global Accounts sub-areas new territory rather than claim depth I do not have. The transferable mechanic I am strong in is structured requirements engineering in high-stakes, edge-case-heavy environments: the same discipline that makes a settlement spec correct is what made a secure-encryption install take two minutes instead of an afternoon.

§ AI-NATIVE STACK

Daily tools, not buzzwords.

- **Claude Code**, in-repo spec drafting and edge-case generation
- **GitHub Copilot**, accelerated requirements and acceptance-criteria writing
- **Cursor**, paired coding and codebase navigation with engineers
- **Lovable**, rapid front-end prototyping before committing to engineering time
- **GPT**, research synthesis and stakeholder communication drafts
- **Gamma.app**, structured narrative decks for GTM and merchant-facing work
- **n8n**, agentic workflow automation and multi-step process design
- **Framer**, lightweight interactive mockups for discovery sessions

§ TECHNICAL ENVIRONMENT

Shipped with, not just listed.

Python, Kotlin (Spring Boot), PostgreSQL, MongoDB, REST APIs, Kafka, Kubernetes, Docker, ArgoCD (GitOps), Jenkins CI/CD, GitLab, Azure DevOps, Dagster, dbt, Shopware, Jira, Confluence, Figma.

§ SIDE PROJECT

PHOENIX882 / [HYPERION GITHUB.COM/HILBERTP](https://github.com/HilbertP) →

A self-built backtesting engine and aFRR balancing-market pipeline, infrastructure-oriented crypto and energy market tooling.

- Hyperion reconstructs marginal clearing prices over merit-order data from the aFRR balancing market; phoenix882 runs trading-strategy backtesting on top.
- Deliberately built without a framework: raw Python pipelines, hand-rolled data structures, so every execution step is inspectable and auditable.
- Sits inside Liberation of Bajor, a personal multi-agent coding framework used for iterating the engine.
- Directly relevant to Financial Operations: the reconciliation mindset required to make every computed price traceable back to source data is the same mindset Primer's settlement specs demand.

§ HOW I WOULD WORK AT PRIMER

First weeks, concrete.

WEEK 1

Listen, map, find the gaps.

Read the existing specs, reconciliation break logs, and merchant support tickets; talk to engineers and the GTM team to understand where the current sub-area generates the most operational pain before forming any opinions.

WEEK 2

Map, validate, prioritise.

Synthesise what I heard into a structured problem map, which breaks are frequent, which are costly, which are caused by missing spec rather than missing engineering, and pressure-test it with the product lead and one merchant.

WEEK 3+

Ship, measure, iterate.

Pick the highest-signal initiative, write a spec that covers the edge cases surfaced in week two, align engineering on feasibility and acceptance criteria, and own the launch readiness through to the first post-launch data review.

I COVER LETTER

Dear Primer team,

I am applying for the Product Manager role on the Financial Operations team. I want to explain why this specific team, not just why Primer.

Reconciliation and settlement operations are where the operational cost of payments lives. The moment a fund doesn't match, the moment an FX rate moves between instruction and settlement, or the moment a currency leg lands in the wrong bucket, these are not abstract product challenges. They have real money attached and require a PM who is genuinely interested in the detail, not one who delegates it to engineering and calls it a technical decision. That description fits me. At the Bundesagentur für Arbeit I owned a national analytics platform where a single indicator computed incorrectly would propagate into published labour-market statistics. I instrumented the ETL pipelines with Dagster and dbt not because the infrastructure

team asked me to, but because traceability from source to output is a product property, not an infrastructure one. I think the same way about reconciliation.

My payments background is real, if not ledger-specific. At Kvitt Payment Solutions I built a mobile group-based P2P payment product from zero and took it to acquisition by Sparkasse inside the girocard ecosystem. That meant owning the full flow: the split logic, the settlement timing, the edge cases where a group member pays twice or a transaction sits in limbo. At Scheidt & Bachmann I owned payment and POS product integration in a fully SAFe setup, moving research results into production across a matrix organisation. Neither role put me in front of a treasury FX engine, and I will not pretend otherwise, but the problem-framing and spec-writing discipline required to handle real money and real settlement states is something I have practiced.

The expectation that a PM here defines what is worth solving rather than waiting for a fully formed brief is one I take seriously. At EMIL Group I joined an 18-person delivery organisation that had lost its senior engineers and its client trust, with no clear mandate beyond "fix it." I restructured the team, cut the roadmap, and shipped the Claims Center, a net-new product, from concept to production. At Rohde & Schwarz I pushed into the customer workshops myself because a second-hand summary of user behaviour is not enough to make a good product decision. I discovered that the beautiful UI nobody used and redirected the product to what engineers actually clicked on. That kind of autonomous problem-definition is how I work by default, not on request.

On the technical side: I can read a schema, write a SQL query, review an API contract, and understand why a reconciliation break might be a timing issue rather than a logic error. I have run GitOps delivery with ArgoCD, integrated CI pipelines, and contributed code where necessary to unblock a spec. I am not an engineer, but I am fluent enough that engineers do not have to translate for me, and that makes the feasibility conversation faster and more honest.

Primer's remote-first, writing-heavy, low-bureaucracy culture is the environment I function best in. I have worked remotely since 2017, I write specifications rather than slide decks by preference, and I give direct feedback as a default rather than a style choice. I am looking for a product role where precision is required, not just encouraged.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*

II CURRICULUM VITAE

§ BEARING

Product manager with 13 years of end-to-end ownership in regulated, detail-heavy domains: fintech, defence AI, public-sector analytics, insurance, and healthcare. I am most effective when the problem is messy, the edge cases are expensive, and the engineering team needs a counterpart who can write a precise spec without a fully formed brief to start from. I run continuous discovery, turn technical constraints into prioritised roadmaps, and lead cross-functional teams through agile delivery from concept to post-launch iteration.

§ WHAT I CAN DO

Payments and fintech: P2P payment product ownership, POS and forecourt payment integration, PSP flow design, girocard ecosystem, SAFe delivery in payment infrastructure.

Operational and back-office product: ETL pipeline ownership, Dagster, dbt, PostgreSQL, tracing data from source to output; structured requirements for edge-case-heavy workflows.

Product ownership: requirements engineering, user stories, acceptance criteria, backlog refinement, sprint planning, UAT, Jira, Confluence, Figma, Miro.

Product management: continuous discovery, product vision and roadmap, prioritisation, MVP and PoC, A/B testing, user research and interviews, go-to-market support.

Agile and scaled delivery: Scrum, Kanban, SAFe, ART, PI planning.

Stakeholder and leadership: cross-functional team leadership, C-level reporting, workshop facilitation, conflict resolution, change management.

Technical environments: Kubernetes, Docker, ArgoCD (GitOps), Jenkins CI/CD, REST APIs, Python, Kotlin, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Kafka, Git, GitLab, Azure DevOps.

AI products and tooling: LLM agents, agentic workflows, prompt and context engineering, Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, Cursor, Lovable.

Analytics and data: KPI definition, funnel and churn analysis, Matomo, MicroStrategy.

Governance: GDPR/DSGVO, Deputy IT Security Officer, identity management, budget and financial planning.

§ PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

ROHDE & SCHWARZ · PRODUCT MANAGER · DEFENCE AI / DATA PLATFORM 2024 TO 2025

Introduced GitOps delivery with ArgoCD across a multinational team; rollout time fell from days to 30 minutes and the platform became hotfix-capable. Redirected the product from a UI-led design to a developer-code-first approach after instrumented user observation showed zero engagement with the original flow.

BUNDESAGENTUR FÜR ARBEIT · PRODUCT MANAGER · PUBLIC-SECTOR ANALYTICS 2023 TO 2024

Integrated test automation into Jenkins and introduced Dagster and dbt so quarterly imports ran without hand-holding. Migrated a bare-metal system fully into containers; carried a full UI relaunch through the same period. Deputy IT Security Officer.

CLINET PLATFORMS · PRODUCT OWNER · HEALTHCARE MOBILE APP 2023

Cut a backlog a three-person team could not deliver to the top 10% of features; user acceptance rose fivefold. Implemented the CGM interface into KIS workflows: digital anamnesis time fell from 30 minutes to 5.

EMIL GROUP · PRODUCT MANAGER · INSURANCE B2B SAAS 2022

Restructured an 18-person delivery organisation into three lean teams; attrition fell from near-total exodus to one departure. Shipped the Claims Center from concept to production, cutting time-to-market for a new insurance product from months to under a week.

SCHEIDT & BACHMANN · PRODUCT OWNER · RETAIL PAYMENTS / POS 2021 TO 2022

Moved research results into production across a matrix organisation in a fully SAFe setup with agile release trains and PI planning. Retail and forecourt payment systems.

BUNDESDRUCKEREI · INTERIM PRODUCT OWNER · SECURE DATA PLATFORM 2021

Data structures and identity management for the Robert Koch Institute programmes DIM and DESH.

AOK ITSCARE · PROXY PRODUCT OWNER · HEALTH INSURANCE / E- COMMERCE 2019 TO 2020

Migrated a legacy procurement system to Shopware for three AOK insurers and roughly 20,000 employees; still in production.

ENERCON · PROJECT LEAD · SITE IT MODERNISATION 2019

Full IT modernisation of a wind-energy production site, end to end.

WALDBURG-ZEIL KLINIKEN · PRODUCT OWNER · CLINICAL NETWORK 2017 TO 2018

WLAN rollout across nine hospitals.

§ FOUNDER & EARLY-STAGE EXPERIENCE

CONSTRUCT8 · FOUNDER AND PRODUCT MANAGER · CONSTRUCTION STAFFING MARKETPLACE 2025 TO 2026

Zero-to-one two-sided B2B marketplace; anonymity-until-payment model, WhatsApp and Telegram as product surface, LLM agents across the funnel.

QCRYPT AG · CO-FOUNDER AND PRODUCT OWNER · QUANTUM-SECURE ENCRYPTION 2016 TO 2021

Shipped a three-layer encryption product with a sub-two-minute install; later Chair of the board.

KVITT PAYMENT SOLUTIONS · FOUNDER AND CFO · FINTECH / P2P PAYMENTS 2013 TO 2018

Built a mobile group-based P2P payment product from zero; acquired and operated by Sparkasse inside the girocard ecosystem.

§ LANGUAGES

German, native. English, C2.

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